



Big dipper

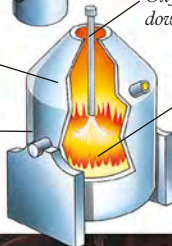
Steel girders are dipped in a bath of melted zinc to stop them from rusting. This process is known as galvanizing.

Iron waiting to be converted



Upright converter

In 40 minutes the converter can make 385 tons of steel.



Oxygen rushes down this tube.

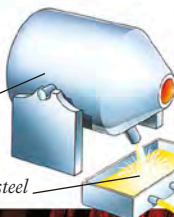
Scrap iron can be put into the converter, too.

Rust buster

You would not want to eat with rusty cutlery! So chromium is added to steel to make an alloy called stainless steel.



Tipped-up converter



Hot steel

When the strips of steel are cold they can be squashed by rollers into flat slabs.



2. Iron in, steel out

The liquid iron is poured into a converter. After a powerful jet of oxygen has burned out the impurities and most of the carbon, the converter is tipped up to pour out steel.



Plane wrapper

Aluminum is a marvelous metal. Thin sheets are wrapped around chocolate to preserve its taste. Thick sheets are made into jumbo jets. Aluminium is used to make planes because it does not rust, and it is very light. The aluminium is made as stiff as steel by adding a little copper.



3. Taking shape

Hot, freshly made steel is poured into a big tray. When it has almost set, nozzles are opened and steel oozes out, like toothpaste out of a tube.

